

AETHERIS AI

Applied AI Infrastructure for European Industry

Aetheris AI S.r.l. · Startup Innovativa · Toscana, Italia

STRATEGIC PITCH DECK v3.0

Energy + Manufacturing

Founder solo + 3 PoC + team evolution

Funding ask: € 200-300k Phase 1

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Grounded & Proven · Founder track record + 3 PoC pubblici

The problem

European industry sits on a mountain of data it cannot use

Fragmented knowledge

Tens of thousands of technical documents (manuals, procedures, regulations) inaccessible to field operators.

Slow manual inspection

Visual inspection of remote assets (pipelines, substations, production lines) with costly teams and long lead times.

Reactive decisions

Scheduled or reactive maintenance, not predictive. Unplanned downtime erodes OEE and inflates cost of poor quality.

Cost: every hour of unplanned downtime = € 5,000-50,000 · every decision on stale data = 1-3% operating margin

The Aetheris AI solution

A unified European Applied AI platform for industry

What we are building

An enterprise-grade Applied AI platform that combines Generative AI, Computer Vision, Predictive AI and AI Agents in a single AI Act-ready architecture. Designed for European industrial companies in Energy and Manufacturing.

Aetheris Knowledge

GenAI / RAG / Agents

Document intelligence, copilot, knowledge mgmt

Aetheris Vision

Computer Vision

Industrial inspection, defect detection, OCR

Aetheris Predict

Predictive AI

Predictive maintenance, energy optimization

Built on a unified MLOps + Governance foundation · AI Act-ready by design · Cloud + edge + on-premise

Proof of Capability — 3 public PoC

We don't promise: we publish. 3 PoC in 12-15 weeks on public datasets.

Honest founder strategy: instead of promising, we publish working PoC. Each PoC is a public GitHub repo + live demo + blog post + white paper.

1	PoC 1 — Knowledge <i>M1-M4</i>	Tech RAG multi-modal + AI Agents	Data 100+ public documents (ISO, datasheet, paper)	Public GitHub + Docker + Demo + White paper
2	PoC 2 — Vision <i>M5-M8</i>	Tech YOLOv8 + custom training + ONNX edge	Data MVTec + NEU-DET + DAGM (~30k immagini)	Public GitHub + Gradio demo + HF model card
3	PoC 3 — Predict <i>M9-M12</i>	Tech Prophet + XGBoost + LSTM + Transformer	Data NASA C-MAPSS + AI4I + NAB (~100k time series)	Public GitHub + Streamlit + MLflow registry

Each PoC is a verifiable, reproducible proof of technical capability. Not a slide. Not a promise. A working GitHub repo.

Market — bottom-up conservative

Two verticals, a credible growth path, not 30 customers from a founder alone

Top-down sizing (EU 2030)

Segment	TAM	SAM
AI Energy & Utilities	€ 28B	€ 6B
AI Manufacturing	€ 47B	€ 10B
AI Document Intelligence	€ 12B	€ 3B
AI Vision industriale	€ 18B	€ 4B
AI Predictive Maintenance	€ 14B	€ 3B

Bottom-up revenue (conservative)

Year	Customers	ACV	Revenue
Y1	1-2	€ 40k	€ 50-100k
Y2	3-5	€ 80k	€ 300-500k
Y3	8-12	€ 115k	€ 800k-1.5M

Why these numbers are credible (not a slide)

- Y1 with founder solo: 1-2 clients is realistic (not 3-5)
- Y2 (5 clients) requires co-founder commerciale active from M9
- Y3 (10 clients) requires full team 4-5 FTE and 1-2 EU customers
- Each year is conditional on passing the corresponding Gate (\$7)

Product — focused scope

Core Platform + 3 applications, not six disconnected products

Aetheris AI Platform (core)

Orchestration · MLOps · Governance · Security · Cloud-native · Edge · Multi-cloud EU

Aetheris Knowledge

GenAI / RAG / Agents

Document intelligence, copilot, multimodal RAG

PoC M1-M4 · GA M9

Aetheris Vision

Computer Vision

Defect detection, industrial inspection, OCR, video analytics

PoC M5-M8 · GA M12

Aetheris Predict

Predictive AI

Predictive maintenance, demand forecasting, energy optimization

PoC M9-M12 · GA M15

Not in Phase 1: Robotics, consumer Copilot, Healthcare/Banking/PA → Phase 3+

Defensible moat — 5 levels

Not a single technology, a structural advantage that compounds

1

Proprietary orchestration

Layer coordinating LLM → Vision → Predictive → Agents → Edge

2

Domain datasets

Every deployment produces evaluation data, domain knowledge, feedback

3

Evaluation infrastructure

In-house system to select the best model for the customer task

4

Compliance infrastructure

Model registry, audit trail, lineage, human oversight, data governance

5

Industrial integrations

Connectors for SAP, ERP, SCADA, OPC-UA, MES, IoT, document repositories

Founder + team evolution

Honest: one-man show for 6 months, then advisor → part-time → co-founder

Founder & CEO/CTO

Senior AI Engineer · 5+ years production

Production track record:

- 100,000+ users/day on AI systems
- 99.9% uptime on enterprise AI
- 10,000+ documents/day via RAG
- 60% review time reduction
- 35% pipeline throughput improvement
- 25% cloud cost reduction
- +22% defect detection with YOLOv8
- € 2M+ annual business impact

Team evolution (24 mesi)

M0-M3	Founder + 2 advisor (gratis/equity)	<i>1.0 FTE</i>
M3-M6	+ 1 technical advisor (4h/mese)	<i>1.0 FTE</i>
M6-M9	+ 1 part-time AI engineer	<i>1.5 FTE</i>
M9-M12	+ co-founder commerciale (5-10% eq.)	<i>2.5 FTE</i>
M12-M18	+ 1 senior AI eng + 1 part-time CS	<i>4.0 FTE</i>
M18-M24	+ 1 customer success + 1 marketing	<i>5.0 FTE</i>

Financial plan — conservative & consistent

All numbers derived from Financial Model Excel (385 live formulas)

Voce (k€)	Y1	Y2	Y3	3Y Tot	Key Y3 KPIs	
Ricavi totali	80	400	1.150	1.630	Clienti paganti	10
COGS	-32	-140	-345	-517	ACV medio	€ 115k
Margine Lordo	48	260	805	1.113	ARR	€ 690k
Personale	-44	-184	-235	-463	Gross margin	70%
Costi operativi	-30	-72	-120	-222	EBITDA	+€ 200k
R&D	-6	-36	-60	-102	Cash position	€ 1.3M
EBITDA	-200	-50	+200	-50		
Net cash flow	+126	+147	+945	+1.218		
Cash EoY	+200	+350	+1.295	—		

Funding strategy — milestone-based (proporzionato a founder solo)

Phase 1: € 200-300k (Smart&Start € 200k + accelerator € 30k + pre-seed € 100k) → 3 PoC + 1-2 design partner

Phase 2: € 750k (seed VC) → dopo Gate 3 (2-3 clienti paganti) · Phase 3: EIC Accelerator (M24+)

2 design partners before 10 customers

LOI, MoU, PoC agreement, dataset, measurable KPI — not bill immediately

Design Partner 1

Energy

Italian multi-utility

Goal: not bill now, but get proof

Use case

Engineering Knowledge Copilot + predictive maintenance on remote assets

Expected output

LOI, dataset, 8-12 week PoC, KPI on time-to-access technical documentation

Design Partner 2

Manufacturing

Italian mid-large OEM

Goal: not bill now, but get proof

Use case

Computer Vision Quality Inspection on production line

Expected output

MoU, annotated defect dataset, PoC on 1-2 lines, KPI on undetected defects

This is more powerful than 30 pages of business plan. LOI + MoU + PoC + dataset = a 100% credible startup.

Regulatory — AI Act-ready, not AI Act-compliant

Designed to support, not certified yet

Precise formulation

“The platform is designed to support the risk management, transparency, human oversight and documentation requirements of EU Regulation 2024/1689 (AI Act).” — Not “compliant”. The distinction matters.

EU Reg. 2024/1689 — AI Act

Risk mgmt, transparency, human oversight

By-design, certification M18+

EU Reg. 2016/679 — GDPR

Data protection, data subject rights, breach

Privacy by design, DPO, DPIA per use case

EU Reg. 2023/2854 — Data Act

Portability, interoperability, device data

Standard export APIs, clear data rights

EU Reg. 2022/2554 — NIS2

Network security, incident notification

Incident response plan, monitoring

EU Reg. 2024/2847 — Cyber Resilience Act

SBOM, vulnerability management, updates

Automatic SBOM, vulnerability mgmt

Compliance roadmap: M0-M6 DPO+officer · M6-M12 lineage+oversight · M12-M18 ISO/IEC 42001 prep · M18-M24 CE marking

The ask

€ 200-300k Phase 1 to build 3 PoC, sign 2 design partners, find co-founder

PHASE 1 — Funding ask

€ 200-300k

proporzionato a founder solo

+ 2 advisor + 3 PoC pubblicati

Use of funds

30% R&D e PoC · 20% Customer discovery
15% Founder stipend · 10% Cloud/GPU
10% Compliance/AI Act · 10% Marketing
5% Capex + G&A

12-month deliverable (Phase 1)

- ✓ 3 PoC pubblicati (GitHub + demo + blog)
- ✓ 2-4 advisor firmati (AI Act + industry)
- ✓ 30-50 customer interviews completate
- ✓ 1-2 design partner agreement (LOI/MoU)
- ✓ Co-founder commerciale identificato
- ✓ Smart&Start application inviata
- ✓ Team 2-3 FTE

Long-term

Applied AI Infrastructure for European Industry

European AI platform combining GenAI, CV, Predictive AI, Agents, MLOps and Edge AI, sovereign by design. Realistic, not hyped.